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Beat That!

Digit Caption

"And that one's for Rs 30 a kg!"

Every month, *Digit* will carry a caption for a photo. Come up with something funnier, and beat the *Digit* team at their own game!

Last Month's Winner!

Samraat Reddy, Chennai is the winner this month for his caption: Behind every man, oops, Robot, there is a woman!

Send your captions to beatthat@thinkdigit.com and win a book!

Computer Systems

A Programmer's Perspective

By Randal E Bryant and David O' Hallaron
Published by Pearson Education



outdate CDs with its storage capacity of almost 500,000 songs, and its ability to "read into a listener's mood and play songs to suit it".

The device is "much more than hard disk technology," claims general manager Ratish Pandey. "It is infused with intelligence such that it automatically skips, tags, retrieves and sorts a listener's preference

track is being played," he says. A "positive" button on the device indicates a liking for a particular song, which the system will automatically repeat.

The system can "customise" songs by recognising the frequency with which it is played. If you opt to listen to a popular song more than once, the system remembers to store and replays it. "The biggest advantage is one does not have to produce a playlist every time a song is to be played. Since the system stores the contents of almost 350 CDs, citing a category would suffice," says Pandey.

HUGE GROWTH EXPECTED

Mobile Gaming In India

The Indian mobile gaming business currently represents five per cent of the world market. It is in its infancy, with half a dozen major game

developers and four service providers offering games to subscribers.

A few technology companies are now planning to transform India into a global hub for generating gaming content.

India is seeing an explosive growth in the mobile phone user base, and the number of mobile phone subscriptions has already overtaken the number of landlines. Analysts say the generation of gaming content for domestic as well as overseas clients may become the Next Big Thing after IT outsourcing.

According to In-Stat/MDR, a US-based tech industry research firm, the Indian mobile gaming market is poised to generate \$336 million in revenue by 2009.

"With half a dozen major developers, along with a variety of start-ups, we expect India's influence to grow in the evolving mobile gaming sector," said Clint Wheelock, director of In-Stat/MDR. "India has a fast-growing wireless subscriber base of its own, and its high-quality and cost competitive

software industry is well positioned to be a key global player in gaming content," Wheelock said. "It is a multi-million dollar market, both in terms of software development and end-user consumption." The number of people playing games on cell phones will swell during the next few years, generating billions for developers, Wheelock added.

POSES SECURITY THREATS

'KaZaA Is Spyware'

The immensely popular peer-to-peer program KaZaA has been rated as the No 1 spyware threat on the Internet, according to Computer Associates International.

CA found that KaZaA posed a greater threat than other programs in its list of top five spyware because of its widespread popularity; KaZaA claims that the program has so far been downloaded 214 million times. Classifying a popular software such as



Illustrations Shyam Shriram

instantly," he adds. "If a listener does not like a particular song and presses the "negative" button on the system, the device skips the song every time the